Yuanjun Feng

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Profile

I am a human-centered AI researcher studying how people understand, trust, and collaborate with AI systems. I combine behavioral experiments and mixed-methods user research with hands-on development of LLM evaluation platforms and prototypes. Outside of research, I am also a **photographer**.

Education

HEC Lausanne, Université de Lausanne *Feb 2024 – Expected Feb 2027*

Ph.D. in Information Systems

- Research Interests: LLM agents, human-AI interaction, computational social science
- Advisor: Prof. Yash Raj Shrestha

École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne *Sep 2020 – Oct 2023*

M.Sc. in Management, Technology, and Entrepreneurship
Minor in Energy

Huazhong University of Science and Technology *Sept 2016 – Jun 2020*

B.Eng. in Energy and Power Engineering
B.Econ. in Economics (Dual Degree)

Publications & Working Papers

*equal contribution

Noise, Adaptation, and Strategy: Assessing LLM Fidelity in Decision-Making
Yuanjun Feng, *Vivek Choudhary, Yash Raj Shrestha*
ACL Anthology, published in ***EMNLP 2025***

- Designed LLM simulations in decision-making and identified limitations of synthetic data in the social sciences.

Contextualizing Recommendation Explanations with LLMs: A User Study
Yuanjun Feng, *Stefan Feuerriegel, Yash Raj Shrestha*
doi:10.1609/icwsm.v20i1.42667, published in ***AAAI ICWSM 2026***

- Led an online experiment with 759 participants and follow-up interviews with 30 participants to assess the impact of LLM-generated recommendation explanations on user perceptions in the context of movie recommendations.

The Effect of Education in Prompt Engineering: Evidence from Journalists
Amirsiavosh Bashardoust, **Yuanjun Feng***, Dominique Geissler*, Stefan Feuerriegel, Yash Raj Shrestha*
doi:10.1609/icwsm.v20i1.42634, published in ***AAAI ICWSM 2026***

- Conducted a field experiment with 29 professional journalists to investigate the impact of prompt engineering training on the perceived effectiveness of LLMs and output quality in science communication.
- Demonstrated that prompt engineering training improves journalists' perceived expertise and revealed mixed effects on output quality, reader engagement, and content clarity depending on task complexity.

Cognitive homophily in Human–AI ensembles: Explaining the quality–satisfaction trade-off
Yuanjun Feng, *Vivek Choudhary, Arianna Marchetti, Ella Miron-Spektor, Phanish Puranam, Yash Raj Shrestha, Nety Wu*
SSRN 6924659, Under review at ***PNAS Nexus***

- Developed the "Ensemble Machine" platform to enable human-AI ensemble configurations in ideation tasks.
- Analyzed how configurations between humans and AI impact human perceptions of competence, autonomy, and output quality, offering insights for designing more effective human-AI collaboration systems.

Beyond Surface Cues: Disentangling Sociocultural Signals in Multilingual LLMs
***Yuanjun Feng**, Tanzhou Liu, Stefan Feuerriegel, Yash Raj Shrestha*
https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.23026, Working Paper

- Designed a Human-in-the-Loop multi-agent framework to audit intersectional sociocultural bias of LLMs across English, French, and Chinese.
- Analyzed nearly 90,000 outputs from 12 LLMs across 18 occupations, showing that bias representation varies systematically across languages and tasks, and proposing a framework to separate surface-level lexical shortcuts from meaningful cross-cultural patterns.

Funding & Grants

- **HEC Research Fund**, HEC Lausanne, University of Lausanne — CHF 4,000, *2024 – 2025*
- **Swiss Academy of Humanities and Social Sciences (SAGW/SASH)**, Framework Credit — CHF 1,000, *2025*

Industry Experience

Machine Learning Engineer Intern *Zurich, Switzerland*
Legartis Technology AG *Jul 2022 – Mar 2023*

- Optimized a text-classification pipeline by integrating six monolingual classifiers under the PyTorch framework; deployed the system, reducing training compute footprint by 83%.
- Integrated report-generation feature into the workflow based on FastAPI under the Django framework.
- Built ETL pipelines to migrate and integrate data for a legal Q&A model.

Business Analyst Intern *Zurich, Switzerland*
Z-PUNKT Consulting *Sep 2021 – Jun 2022*

- Maintained the MS365 digital collaboration platform to enhance team productivity and communication.
- Developed automated workflows with Power Automate; designed interactive dashboards with Power BI.

Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant, Artificial Intelligence in Business, BSc course at UNIL, *2023 – Present*

Presentations

- AI Usage and Regulation Workshop *2025, Lausanne, Switzerland*
- Pujiang Innovation Forum: AI & Ethics: Sino-Swiss Intercultural Dialogue. *2024, Shanghai, China*

Academic Service

- **Reviewer**: International Conference on Wirtschaftsinformatik (2024–Present), ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2024–Present), The International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM) (2025–Present), European Conference on Machine Learning and Principles and Practice of Knowledge Discovery in Databases (ECML-PKDD) (2026–Present).